Machil sector of the Kupwara district.[32] Between 1 May 2010 and 21 September 2010, around 110 people were killed and 537 civilians were injured as a result of being caught in the cross responses to stone pelting. Further, 1,274 CRPF men and 2,747 police personnel were injured during the same period across the valley. Adding to the eruption of violence in the valley was the constant shelling across the LoC by the Pakistani Army. This shelling provided cover for waves of militants to cross the LoC. Thus, a vicious circle of violence was initiated which started scaring away migrant labour employed on the project.

The IB and Army Intelligence claimed that these protests and demonstrations were part of the covert operations of the ISI. Media reports earlier in March had suggested that with ISI direction, Pakistan had once again revived a vicious return of militancy in the state. It was reported that in a meeting held in Muzaffarabad in mid-January 2010, which was chaired by former ISI Chief Lt. Gen. Hamid Gul, the Pakistani Army-created United Jihad Council had called for a reinvigorated jihad until Kashmir was free of Indian occupation. Interestingly, in May 2010, increased activities of militants were reported from across the border in the Neelum Valley in Pakistan-administered Gilgit-Baltistan. The locals reported that large numbers of militants had set up camps in the area with plans of crossing into the Kashmir Valley. This entire cycle of violence saw migrant labour fleeing the Kishenganga project in droves. Further, design changes had to shift key aspects of the project underground to insulate them from attacks by militants. Were these acts of violence in 2010 actually the second step in a smokescreen to provide a host of collateral reasons to make India completely scrap the Kishenganga project?

That Pakistan’s orchestration of this violence was primarily geared towards sabotaging the Kishenganga project became clear when it went to the World Court, praying for work to be halted. It achieved momentary success when the court temporarily halted work on the project in October 2011. This was the third step in Pakistan’s attempt to sabotage the project. After the World Court ruled in favour of India in 2013 and permitted the construction to restart, Pakistani proxies in the valley engineered a wave of